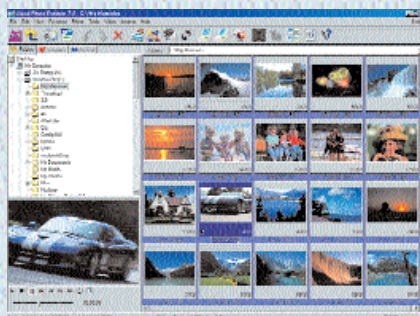


Managing Images

Working with a large collection of images can be a mind-numbing experience to say the least. If a picture is worth a thousand words, then how much justice will a 30-character filename do? Tame those vaguely named images with software that converts, organises and catalogues the album of images on your machine.

If you find it increasingly difficult to remember the name and location of saved files, then try out eGems Collector Pro. One of the most useful features is its ability to store the source of the electronic file in a field it calls 'bibliography'.

ThumbsPlus is a tool used by professionals for image browsing, viewing and organising. It includes some strong image cataloguing features as well as high-end relational database support. It features numerous small yet nifty additions such as



Organise and manipulate digital images and video clips with Ulead Photo Explorer

Auto Clip Save, which automatically saves clipboard content to files, and automatic saving of photo scans.

FotoStation is a more balanced software package, offering impressive image editing features and satisfactory browsing,

viewing, and publishing options to professionals and novices. Its powerful text annotation abilities make it an excellent choice if you need to store a great deal of text information with your images.

If you're averse to buying such software, there are a couple of good free options available. PhotoShoot maintains an accurate inventory of all your photos and other image files. You can easily locate a picture by category, subject, photo ID and the date the picture was taken on.

Another more popular free utility is Ulead Photo Explorer, a visual file manager that works with images and multimedia clips. The software allows you to organise and share your digital files quickly. A digital camera wizard lets you upload your pictures quickly too.



owner before you can use them. And even if what you've found is not copyrighted, don't assume that either Google or Altavista provides legal permission for you to use them.

Image searches come equipped with filters that omit mature images and content. Users can easily toggle the filters on and off. But because of the nature of the search, some images might slip through the cracks.

Designer tips

Aside from resources for designers you can also find expert design tips online. Whether it has to do with the slightly more mundane issue of pagination or advice on how to best exploit your genius, there is a liberal amount of material online to help you.

A sure stop for graphics designers who wish to accentuate their skills by means of a simple, yet meaningful approach through art is www.graphicdesignbasics.com. The site carries numerous articles that bring out some interesting content pertaining to the elements and principles of design including insights on colour, line, texture and more. All this is coupled with an online image gallery that



Graphics Design Basics (above) is a good start to absorbing the essentials of graphic design. Photoshop Cafe (left) has its foundation on thousands of users who contribute to the art and cause of everything Photoshop

authors contribute and use to illustrate the meaning of each rule.

Loaded with goodies, www.photoshopcafe.com is one of the most useful resources on the Web for Photoshop users. The site is packed with information, especially for those wanting greater control and



pieces to the design puzzle are here, free for the taking, but if it's quality you're looking for, don't shy away from letting your money speak the words of art. After all, it's more affordable than your own studio and let's face it, there's no such thing as a free lunch. ■

PRASHANT MASRANI